contrary, I had placed myself in a very vulnerable situation where those who had got offended by my 'arrogance of equal law' alone could help. I found them 'attempting' to teach me my first lesson – 'favour' your seniors blindly, if you want 'favours'. It was a humiliating and repelling atmosphere in the corridors of bureaucracy. I could not bear it any more. I decided to leave for Goa, because my family stood by me as always …

I left for Goa only physically, leaving behind my heart and soul.

In May 1983 a well-known Goan journalist Mario Cabral e Sa interviewed Kiran, who could not hold back her feelings:

I Feel Banished

'Yes in a way I feel banished in Goa,' Kiran Bedi, the high-profile former Delhi 'supercop', told this correspondent. 'Banished in the sense,' she hastened to qualify, 'that I have been separated from my only daughter who had to be kept back on serious medical grounds in Delhi with my mother.'

The little girl suffers from nephritis and after one year of all available allopathic treatment she is now in the hands of a good Delhi homoeopath Dr P. S. Khokkar. Mrs Bedi was posted to Goa recently for a three-year period.

She will not admit that her sudden transfer to Goa had anything to do with the 'famous' traffic tickets issued to Dhirendra Brahmachari [a yoga teacher considered close to the Indira Gandhi family], other than one for wrong parking of the PM's car (remember?). 'We never know what happens in those circles', she said, asserting that she does not go by rumours and Goa was just another posting and a beautiful place too.

Only she sees no way of keeping herself away for three years from her ailing daughter. 'My daughter needs me,' she kept repeating.

Right now she is well on [*sic*] senior police officers' necks deep in CHOGM [Commonwealth Heads of Government Meet] retreat, planning the traffic and security.

(*The Daily*, 11 May 1983)

Kiran remembers that on the publication of this interview, she was asked to offer her first explanation to the then chief secretary of Goa, K. K. Mathur. 'This was a case akin to an injured who is expected not to speak of the pain but remain injured', says Kiran.

'Goa as a place of work is beautiful. Its people are relaxed, friendly and disciplined,' Kiran recalls with fond feelings. 'I had reached a place that had a warmth of its own. Beautiful, noble and warm, I could spend a lifetime at the Aguada Beach, or driving past the tall coconut trees. I drove past innumerable churches and holy crosses. They reminded me of the holy pictures I used to receive as rewards from the Belgian nuns in my Sacred Heart School in Amritsar. I knew I was in another home of God, and I felt comfortable.'

Her 'Crane' reputation had preceded her, much to her surprise. There were expectations of repeat performances splashed all over the Goan newspapers. Citizens of Goa had started to state their problems with regard to traffic movement and regulation and expected one and all to get disciplined just because she had landed there. They expected the 'best' from her.

But what were the resources with which she could provide her 'best'? A total force of just 25